

EXPERIMENT NO: 03

Network Packet Sniffing and Credential Analysis Using Wireshark

DATE:

1. AIM :

To capture and analyze unencrypted network traffic using the Wireshark packet analyzer, isolate HTTP GET and POST request methods, and extract transmitted plain-text login credentials (username and password).

2. DESCRIPTION :

Network packet sniffing is the process of monitoring and capturing data packets passing through a network interface card (NIC). Wireshark utilizes packet capture drivers (Npcap/libpcap) to set the system's NIC into **promiscuous mode**, allowing it to capture all frames traversing the local network segment.

When web applications transmit data using unencrypted protocols such as **HTTP (Hypertext Transfer Protocol)** over TCP port 80, the payload remains in ASCII plain text:

- **HTTP GET Method:** Appends parameters to the URL string. While used primarily for retrieving data, it leaves information visible in server logs and browser histories.
- **HTTP POST Method:** Embeds data within the body of the request header (Content-Type: application/x-www-form-urlencoded). Although hidden from the URL bar, the payload remains completely legible to network sniffers if not protected by TLS/SSL encryption (**HTTPS**).

3. PROCEDURE

Step 1: Interface Initialization

1. Launch Wireshark.
2. Select the active **Wi-Fi** network interface to begin live traffic capture.

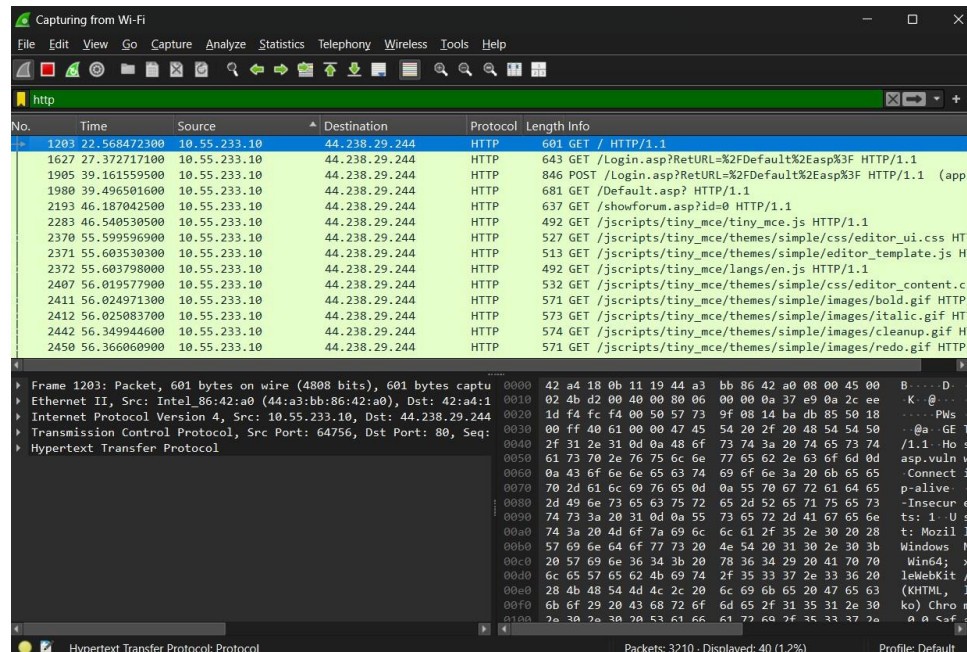


Figure 1: Wireshark Interface Capture Selection

Step 2: Generating Network Traffic

1. Open the target web page in a browser.
2. Enter the credential details (Username: Sadiq7, Password: Sadiq@2006) into the form fields and submit.



Figure 2: Submitting Credentials on Test Web Page

Step 3: Filtering Protocol Traffic

Apply the http filter in the display filter bar to filter out ambient TCP, UDP, and DNS background traffic and isolate application-layer HTTP traffic.

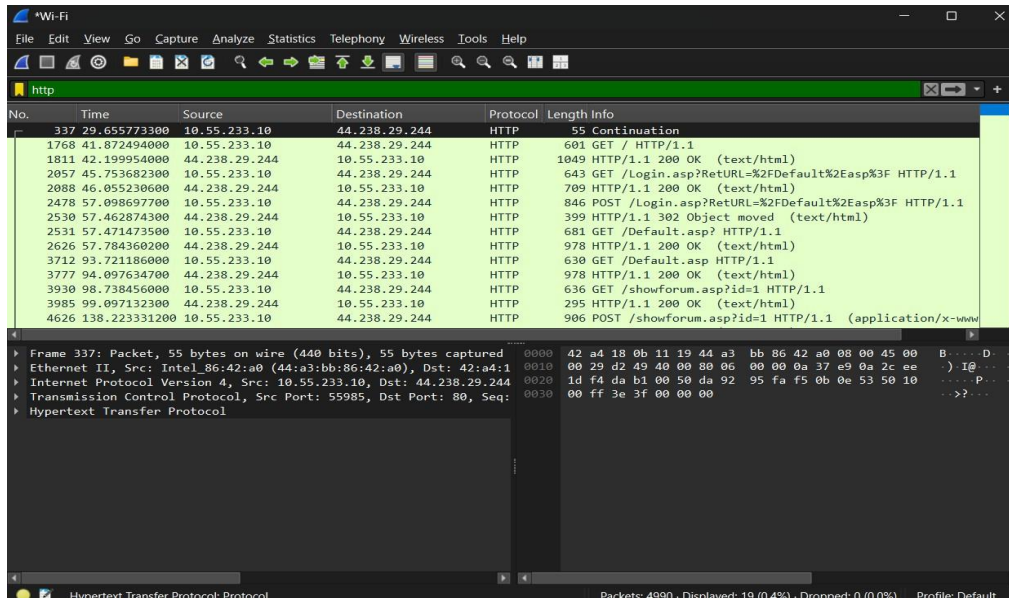


Figure 3: Applying Display Filter for HTTP Protocol

Step 4: Inspecting HTTP GET Requests

Enter the following filter to inspect GET requests:

`http.request.method == "GET"`

Observation: GET packets retrieve page components (/login.aspx), but do not carry submitted form parameters in their payload.

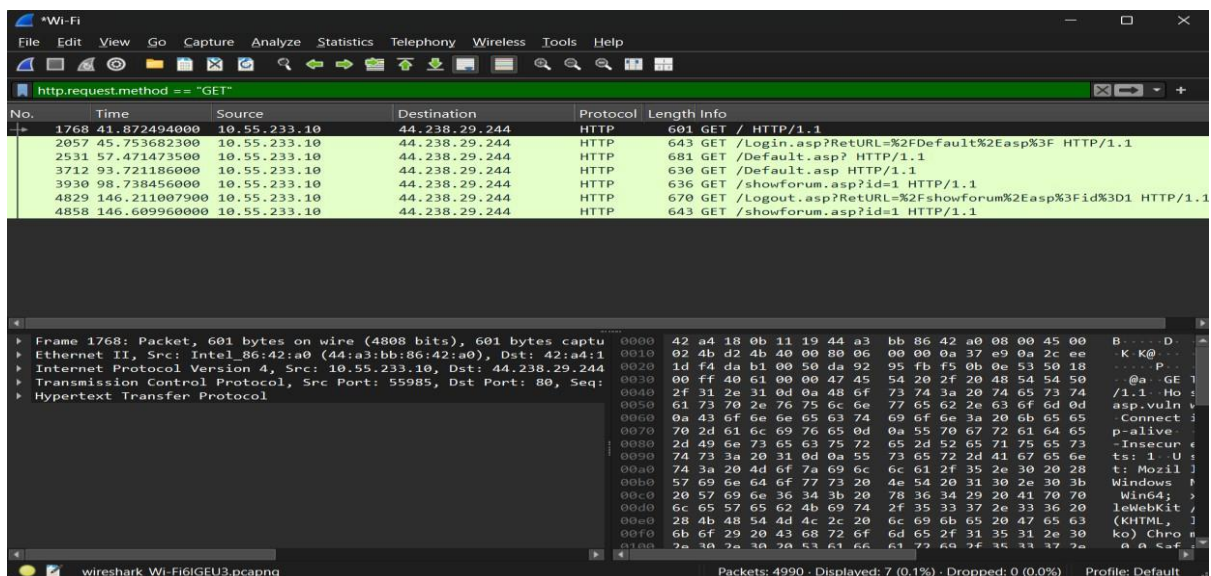


Figure 4: Analysis of Captured HTTP GET Requests

Step 5: Extracting POST Payload and Credentials

Apply the POST filter to locate form submission requests:

```
http.request.method == "POST"
```

Select the packet containing application/x-www-form-urlencoded. In the **Packet Details** pane, expand the **HTML Form URL Encoded** tree to read the plain-text form variables.

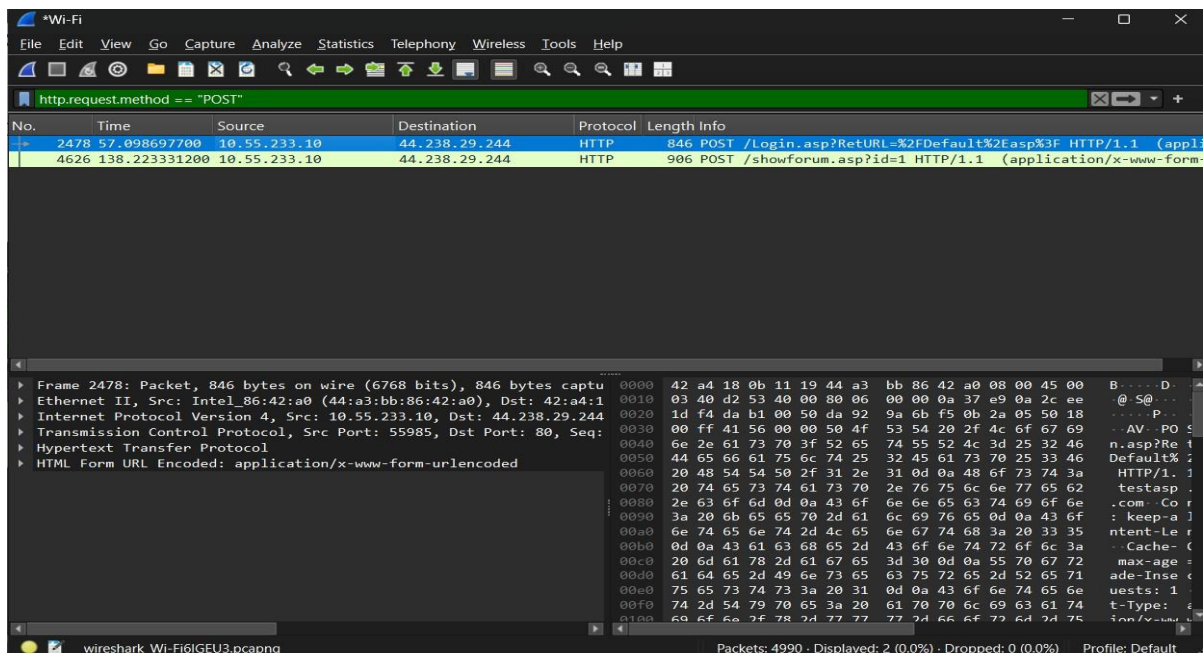


Figure 5: Inspecting HTTP POST Packet Payload

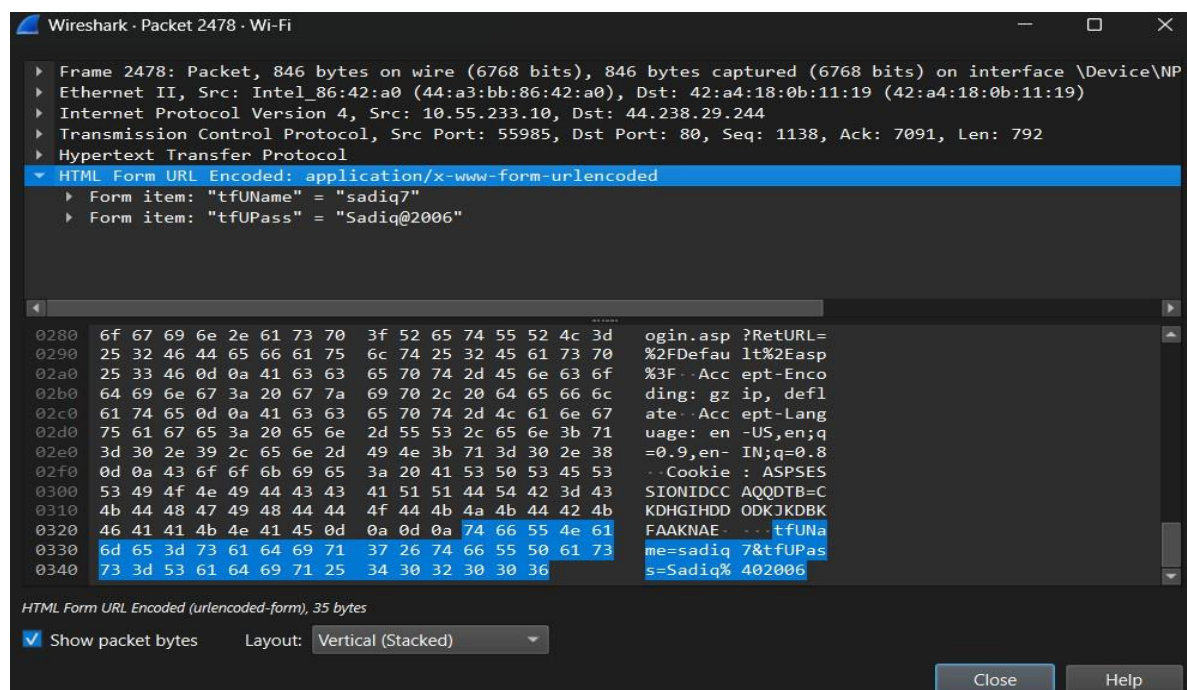


Figure 6: Plain-text Credential Extraction from Form Fields

4. OBSERVATIONS & RESULTS

Extracted Form Parameters

Field Name	Captured Key	Extracted Value
Username	tbUsername	Sadiq7
Password	pass / tbPassword	Sadiq@2006

5. RUBRICS

Criteria & Marks Assigned	Mark Allotted	Mark Awarded
1. GitHub Activity & Submission Regularity	3	
2. Application of Forensic Tools & Practical Execution	3	
3. Documentation & Reporting	2	
4. Engagement, Problem-Solving & Team Collaboration	2	
Total	10	

6. RESULT

The network traffic was successfully captured and analyzed using Wireshark. Plain-text credentials (**Username:** Sadiq7, **Password:** Sadiq@2006) transmitted over HTTP were extracted from the POST request payload.